

Translated

From: e-maxx.ru

Extended Euclidean Algorithm

While the [Euclidean algorithm](#) calculates only the greatest common divisor (GCD) of two integers a and b , the extended version also finds a way to represent GCD in terms of a and b , i.e. coefficients x and y for which:

$$a \cdot x + b \cdot y = \gcd(a, b)$$

It's important to note that by [Bézout's identity](#) we can always find such a representation. For instance, $\gcd(55, 80) = 5$, therefore we can represent 5 as a linear combination with the terms 55 and 80: $55 \cdot 3 + 80 \cdot (-2) = 5$

A more general form of that problem is discussed in the article about [Linear Diophantine Equations](#). It will build upon this algorithm.

Algorithm

We will denote the GCD of a and b with g in this section.

The changes to the original algorithm are very simple. If we recall the algorithm, we can see that the algorithm ends with $b = 0$ and $a = g$. For these parameters we can easily find coefficients, namely $g \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 = g$.

Starting from these coefficients $(x, y) = (1, 0)$, we can go backwards up the recursive calls. All we need to do is to figure out how the coefficients x and y change during the transition from (a, b) to $(b, a \bmod b)$.

Let us assume we found the coefficients (x_1, y_1) for $(b, a \bmod b)$:

$$b \cdot x_1 + (a \bmod b) \cdot y_1 = g$$

and we want to find the pair (x, y) for (a, b) :

$$a \cdot x + b \cdot y = g$$

We can represent $a \bmod b$ as:

$$a \bmod b = a - \left\lfloor \frac{a}{b} \right\rfloor \cdot b$$